Project Title: ClassSync

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About ClassSync:

ClassSync is an extension that will allow students to handle their school schedule effectively with organized calendar management. With ClassSync, students can easily integrate their Canvas calendar into another calendar platform, such as Outlook.This is not something students currently have access to, and our project aims to make this easy and accessible for everyone.

The problem domain for ClassSync is that Canvas calendars do not automatically get synced with students' Outlook calendars. This results in multiple calendars having different events on them and is a confusing way to display information. ClassSync eliminates this by giving students the ability to import their class schedule to their preferred calendar platform.

Why ClassSync is a necessity:

Students tend to have busy schedules, and organizational issues may arise from non-synchronized calendars. Fear of missing classes or deadlines adds unnecessary stress on top of academic pressure. ClassSync will solve these issues by providing an accessible extension that can promptly bring quarter-specific class schedules to any calendar while consolidating information in an organized manner.

Currently, there is a built-in Canvas calendar which keeps track of assignments and deadlines. The Canvas calendar cannot be linked with other calendar platforms, causing it to lack information such as Class times. ClassSync will generate calendar files (.ics) that work across all calendar platforms such as Google Calendar, iCalendar, and Outlook Calendar.

Target Users of ClassSync:

The target users for ClassSync are students at Western Washington University (WWU). This target audience consists primarily of young adults with an average age of 21 who are familiar with web-based applications (Enrollment and Student Services, 2020). Furthermore, students do not often have long consecutive periods of free time, so designing an easy-to-use tool is a necessity. This gives us a good understanding of how we must design ClassSync to best suit its users.

Having WWU students as our target users allows us to test ClassSync while keeping consistent access to the WWU students' needs. We can collect useful feedback on ClassSync, providing us with opportunities to make iterative improvements. Hence, ClassSync will emphasize streamlined features for our focused group of WWU students while facilitating the need for an effective academic calendar.

Student Interviews:

We designed and developed a set of eight interview questions for students. The process was conducted with a combination of in-person and online interviews based on the students' availability. We had four student interviewees in total.

Interview Questions:

1. What tool(s) do you use in your school for course scheduling and assignment management?
2. Which features do you currently use within that tool? Can you describe the features?
3. What do you like about the tool?
4. What improvements would you want to be made to this tool?
5. Is there information you wish you could see when registering for classes?
6. Do you think that deadlines and exam dates are communicated clearly in your class? How do you mark these dates?
7. Do you prefer having your school schedule and personal schedule combined in one calendar?
8. What do you think about the idea of embedding your course schedule into your Outlook calendar?

Summary of Interview Findings:

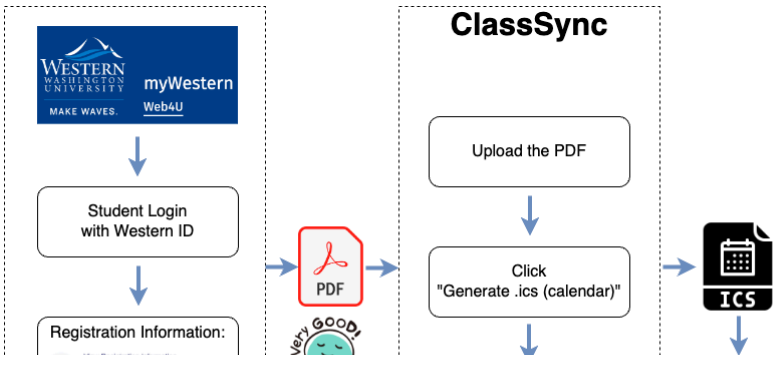
Our interviews involved undergraduate students from WWU as well as a graduate student from outside of WWU for a different perspective. From our interviews, we found that students rely on the calendar feature in learning management systems (LMS), like Canvas or Moodle, for course scheduling and assignment management. They use these tools because all course information, such as deadlines, syllabus, and course content, can be found in one place.

However, they wish for more customization options and consistency across courses in how schedules are organized. Also, participants reflect that these LMS calendars don't include class meeting times, and they have to use Web4U to view their class schedules. They also stated that they would prefer to have their course schedule and personal schedule combined into one calendar.

While Web4U provides a class schedule, it isn't integrated with Canvas, and students cannot download or add events to the timetable. Users need to take a screenshot of their schedule and save it on their phone, which is inconvenient for them.

Features of ClassSync:

We noticed a dissociation between class schedules, course calendars, and personal schedules. To address these issues,

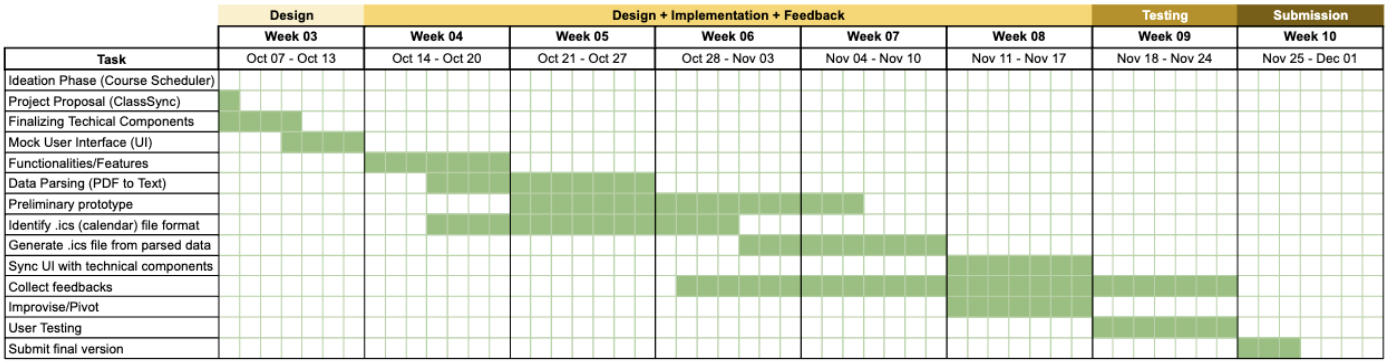


we aim to create an extension with the following features:

1. On ClassSync, students can press a button to a .ics file containing all events from their Canvas calendar, allowing them to import it into another calendar agent. This solves the problem of class schedules not being able to be downloaded or accessed elsewhere. It also allows students to merge their personal and class schedules, which is a feature that the Canvas calendar is lacking.

2. An instructions page instructs students on how to set up and use ClassSync. This helps students with easy-to-understand instructions on how to use ClassSync.

Project Timeline:



Note: The Project Timeline can be separately accessed from this Google Spreadsheet.
